

MSOS Library Syllabus

Grades 6-8 • SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Mrs. Sarah Rocheleau

Librarian • Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Introduction

Welcome to the start of the 2026–2027 school year! Mary, Star of the Sea School is fortunate to have a beautiful, air-conditioned library with thousands of books — some older, award-winning classics, and others brand-new additions to our growing collection. Our library and its resources are available to all students and parents in grades kindergarten through eighth. Our primary goal is to assist students in obtaining recreational and curriculum-related reading materials and to develop and nurture a love for reading and learning. Students are encouraged to borrow books regularly and are responsible for their safe return.

Each homeroom has pre-scheduled library visits. However, books may be borrowed or returned throughout the school day as their teacher allows.

Mary, Star of the Sea School parents are always welcome in our library and are encouraged to borrow books to read to their children.

Borrowing Privileges

Grade Level	Number of Items
K & Grade 1	one book
Grade 2	two books
Grades 3–8	three books, or two books and 1 DVD

Lost or Damaged Books

A replacement fee will be charged for lost or damaged books. Students are asked to either replace the book or cover its cost.

Library Rules & Expectations

Throughout the first month of school (and as needed thereafter), I introduce our library rules and expectations with each class. Please take the time to review our library rules with your child and return the forms with them.

Be Safe

- I will stay in the library and use walking feet.
- I will respect others' personal space.

Be Respectful

- I will use the appropriate voice level for different activities in the library (silence, whisper, talking voice, presenting voice).
- I will listen attentively.
- I will care for books and our library.

Be Responsible

- I will return my library books on time.
- I will replace or cover the cost of damaged or lost books.

Be Cooperative

- I will help others.
- I will take turns talking and listening.
- I will participate in library activities.

GRADES 7-8 ONLY

Middle School Enrichment • Theory of Knowledge (TOK)

In addition to weekly library visits, 7th and 8th graders participate in a Theory of Knowledge (TOK) enrichment strand.

Course Overview

Theory of Knowledge (TOK) is designed to explore how we acquire, evaluate, and use knowledge in various areas of life. Students think critically about what we know, how we know it, and why it matters.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, students will:

- Understand key concepts of Theory of Knowledge.
- Develop critical thinking and reasoning skills.
- Explore different Ways of Knowing (WOKs) and Areas of Knowledge (AOKs).
- Evaluate sources of information for reliability and bias.
- Appreciate diverse perspectives and cultural differences in knowledge.
- Conduct effective research using tools such as EBSCO.
- Develop effective note-taking skills by identifying and recording key ideas, supporting details, and vocabulary from lectures and presentations.
- Correctly document sources in MLA 9 format.
- Prepare a correctly formatted Works Cited or Annotated Bibliography.
- Know and use AI-based tools in a responsible and ethical manner.

- Understand and employ effective reading strategies for each Area of Knowledge.
- Develop and display safe digital citizenship behaviors.
- Learn and use effective presentation techniques focused on the listener.

Class Charter

During the first week of school, middle-school students and Mrs. Rocheleau co-create a class charter — a set of agreements covering classroom safety, responsibility, respect, and cooperation.

Grading

TOK assessment is reflected in the Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLE) portion of the report card, not as a separate letter grade.

Mahalo for your support!